From Imagetext to Worldtext



Language Games and Operative Description in Generative Media

From Imagetext to Worldtext

From imagetext to worldtext. Language games and operative description in generative media.

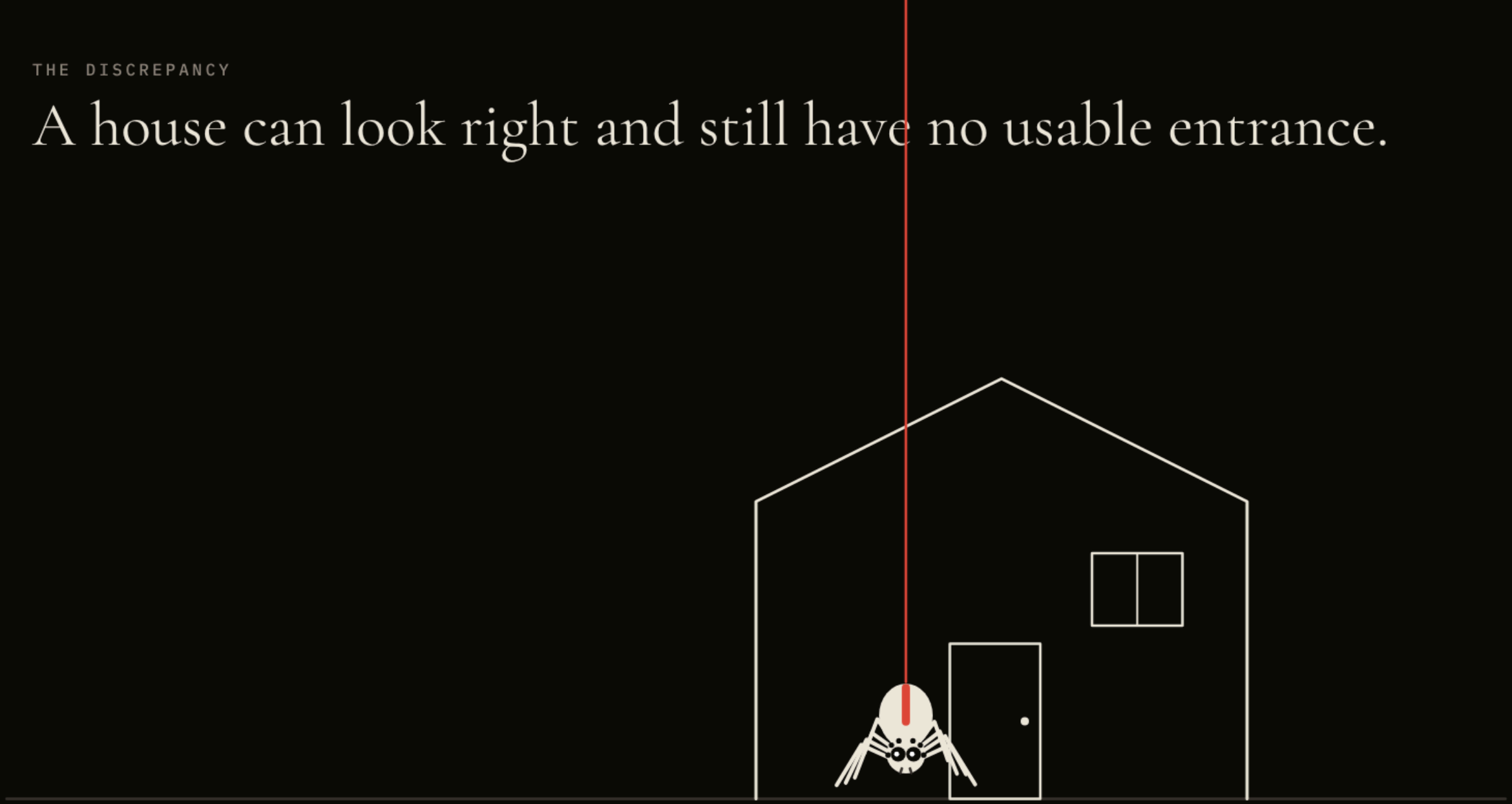
What Bolas does. Bolas drops on its thread, then walks left hanging beneath the title, spinning the title thread under the words; its six small eyes light one by one.

Working title and subtitle from the atlas (Watson Hartsoe, 15 October 2026). Georgia Tech, Digital Media; adviser Jay David Bolter.

Three terms carry the talk. **Operative description**: descriptions participating in consequential activity. **Thick prompting**: the documented, situated interpretive practice through which these activities are specified, inspected, and revised. **Worldtext**: the organization of descriptions, representations, rules, and actions through which a world becomes available across encounters.

THE DISCREPANCY

A house can look right and still have no usable entrance.



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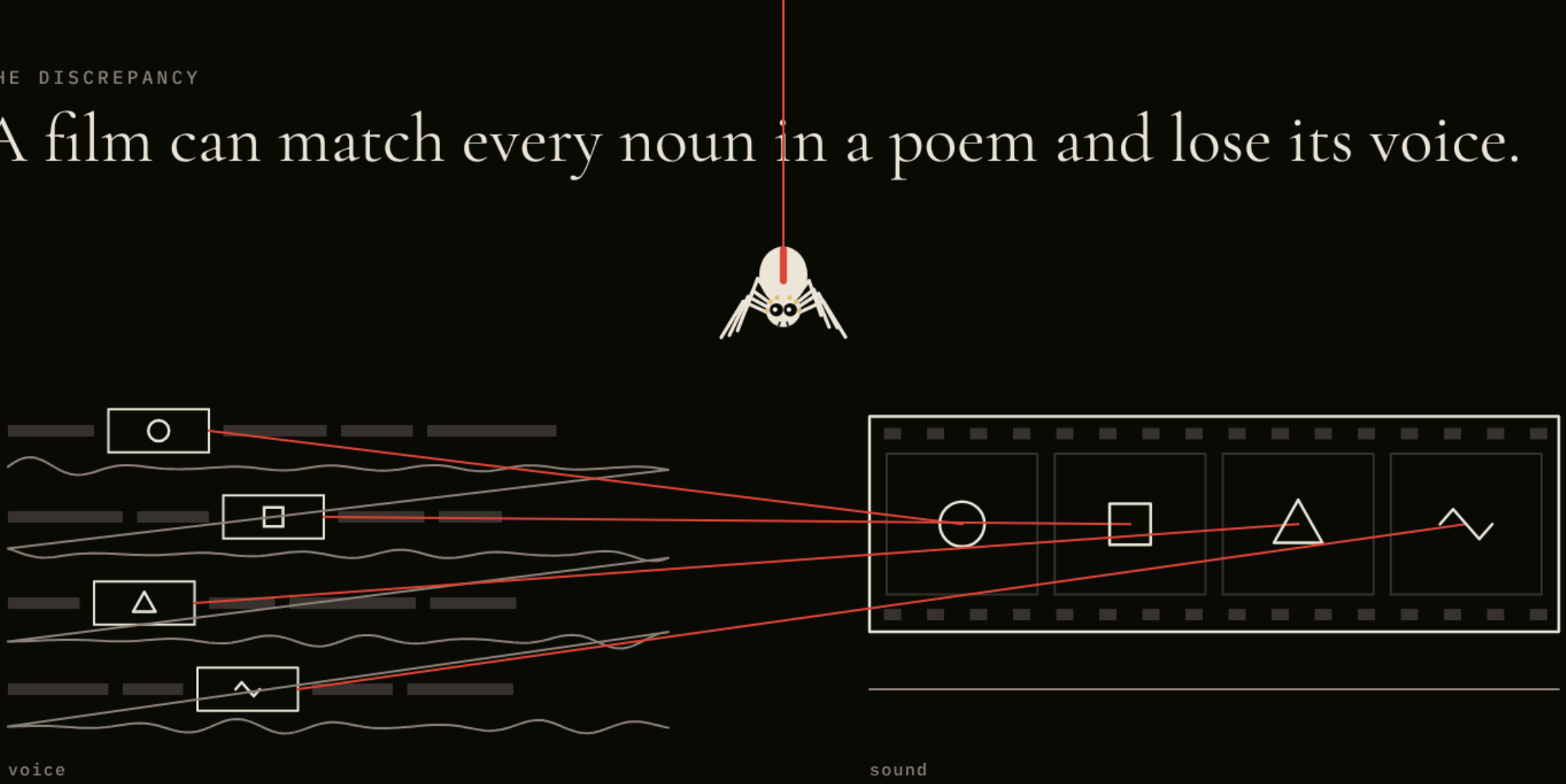
What Bolas does. Bolas walks to the door and pushes it twice; it does not move. The house turns on its axis and shows itself as a flat wall: the door is only drawn.

Opening anomaly (atlas, chapter 1): a generated house looks plausible, but an entrance does not lead anywhere.

Section 1.1: a convincing realization can conceal a failed translation. Use one short episode that can be revisited in the conclusion; do not open with the entire project catalogue.

> Status: framing example. The visual "house that language built" in the Grove is an artistic frame, not proof of construction.

A film can match every noun in a poem and lose its voice.



A film can match every noun in a poem and lose its voice.

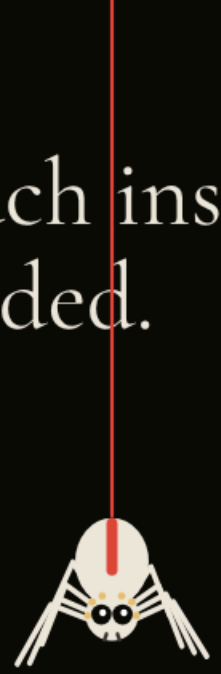
A film can match every noun in a poem and lose its voice.

What Bolas does. Bolas ties each noun of a four-line poem to a frame of film, and each frame gets its picture. The poem's voice runs on under its lines and stops at the edge of the film; the film's sound line stays flat.

Chapter 1 opening anomaly: a poem is illustrated but loses a consequential relation. A poem introduces ambiguity, rhythm, voice, address, memory, perspective, and relations that cannot be reduced to a subject label (atlas, insight 4).

The question is which differences a translation preserves, transforms, or forecloses. The poem drawn here is a diagram of word positions, not a quoted poem.

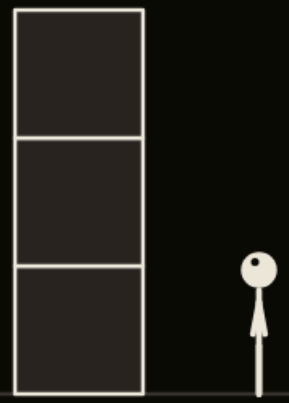
An agent can follow each instruction and help produce an outcome nobody intended.



1 put a block on the road ✓

2 put a block on the block ✓

3 put a block on top ✓



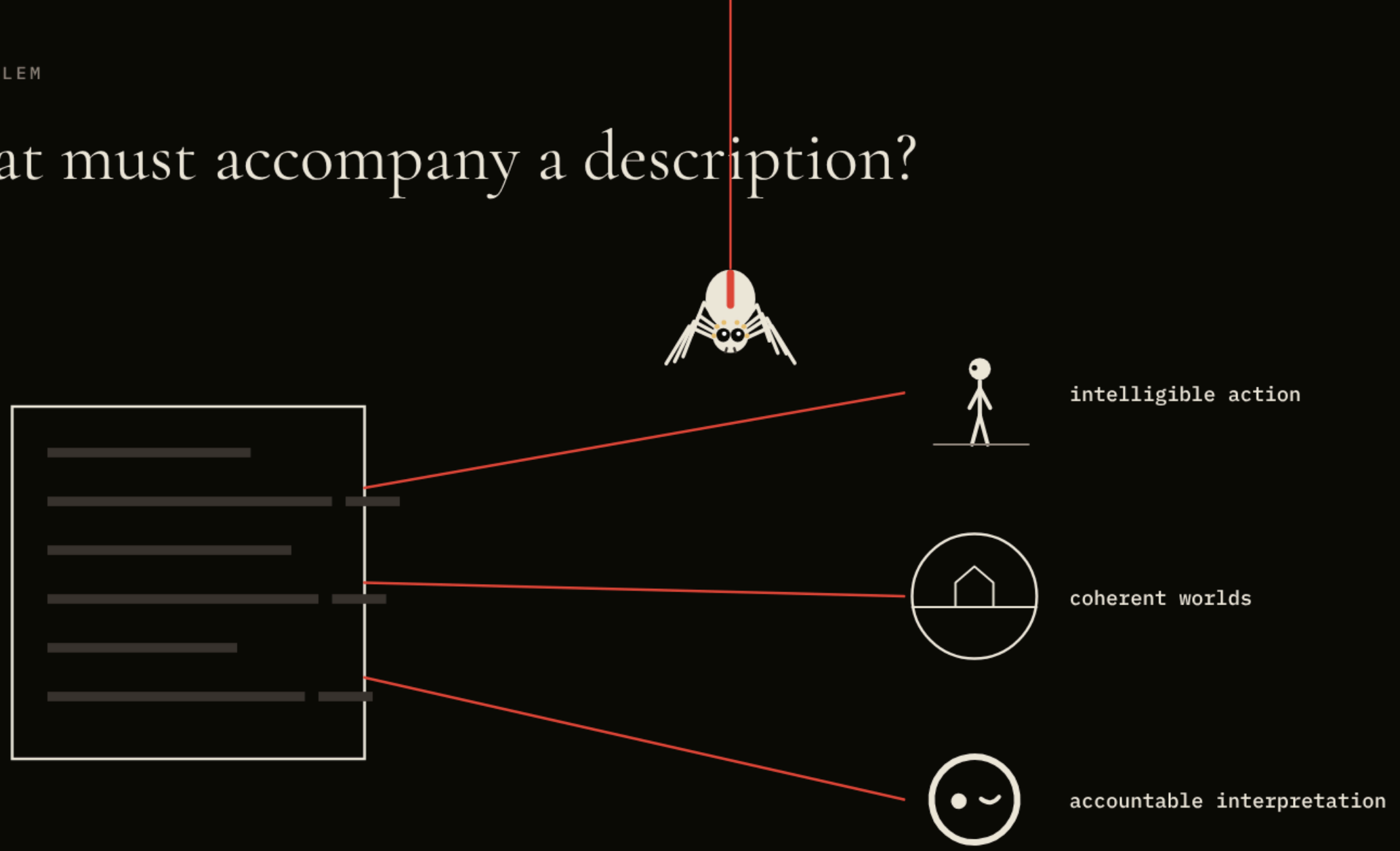
An agent can follow each instruction and help produce an outcome nobody intended.

An agent can follow each instruction and help produce an outcome nobody intended.

What Bolas does. Bolas carries out three instructions, one block each, and each instruction is ticked. Then a small walker comes up the road and stops: the three blocks together close the way.

The third discrepancy anticipates Experiment III: a system can satisfy a local condition while undermining the activity that gave the condition its purpose. More precise instructions can interact in unforeseen ways.

What must accompany a description?



What must accompany a description?

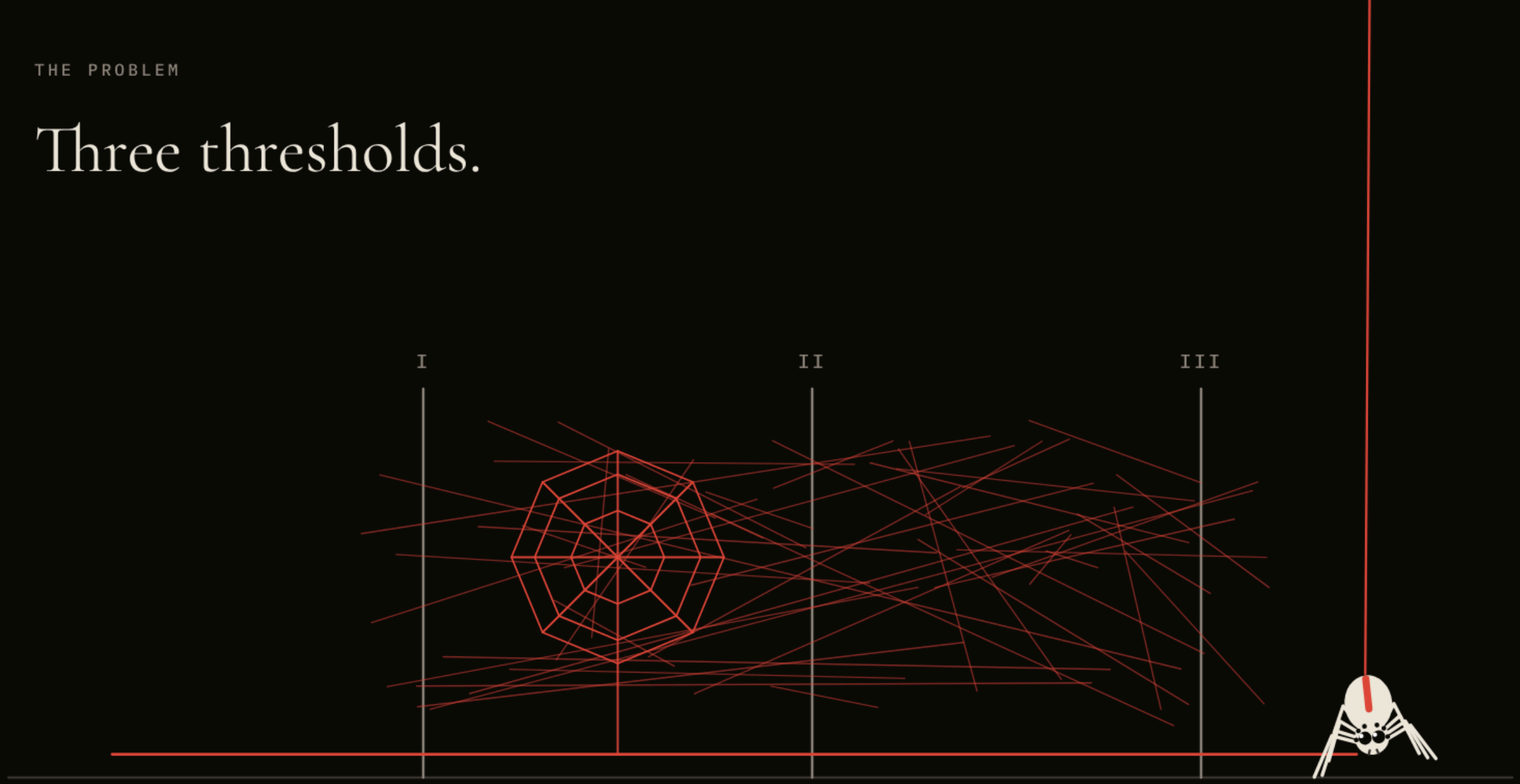
These discrepancies give the dissertation its problem. What must accompany a description for it to support intelligible action, coherent worlds, and accountable interpretation?

What Bolas does. Bolas ties three threads from one description card, as each is named: to a step taken, to a world that holds together, to a mark of who read it.

The dissertation's problem, in Watson's words: what must accompany a description for it to support intelligible action, coherent worlds, and accountable interpretation?

Atlas finding: the work repeatedly asks what remains available after production: the referent, source line, state, branch, interpretation, rejected alternative, and responsible decision. The hinge is continuing authorship.

Three thresholds.



Three thresholds.

The dissertation follows description across three thresholds: when words guide actions, when those actions compose worlds, and when their accumulated consequences exceed what an individual instruction makes intelligible.

What Bolas does. Bolas crosses three lines. After the first it trails one thread; after the second the thread closes into a small web; after the third the web has more threads than Bolas can follow, and it looks back.

The three experiments establish progressively harder conditions. First, can a description guide an action? Second, can its consequences hold together across a world? Third, can we understand and revise what happens when those consequences exceed the instruction?

EXPERIMENT	INITIAL QUESTION	HARDER QUESTION
When words operate	Can a description produce something?	Can we determine what it did and correct it?
When models become worlds	Can descriptions generate an environment?	Can its relations and consequences persist across encounters?
When description exceeds understanding	Can we generate and retrieve more?	Can we interpret, contest, and take responsibility for what accumulates?

These are analytical lenses, not nine required new studies: three bounded case families (building and spatial specification; poetic translation; operative archives).

From thick description to thick prompting.



From thick description to thick prompting.

From thick description to thick prompting. Context becomes something you must communicate, preserve, and revise during production. The unit is a documented encounter: what someone wanted, what context they supplied, what appeared, how they judged it, and what they changed.

What Bolas does. Bolas spins one thread and ties five knots on it, one as each part is named: wanted, supplied, appeared, judged, changed.

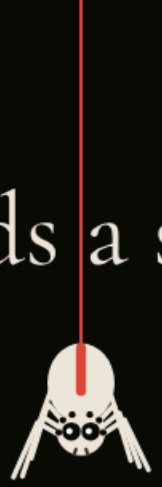
Chapter 2. Establish the method through the movement from anthropological fieldwork to participation in prompting communities (the Midjourney community encounter: learning vocabulary, exemplars, and judgments).

Accumulating detail becomes methodologically useful when you can explain why that detail mattered. Reconstructing an existing record and conducting a new comparison produce different evidence: label reconstructions and hypothetical demonstrations.

> Status: The Grove stages thin names, relations, field notes and the wink. It is a demonstrative interface, not evidence about the earlier community encounter. No new user study is implied.

METHOD

Thick prompting needs a stopping rule.

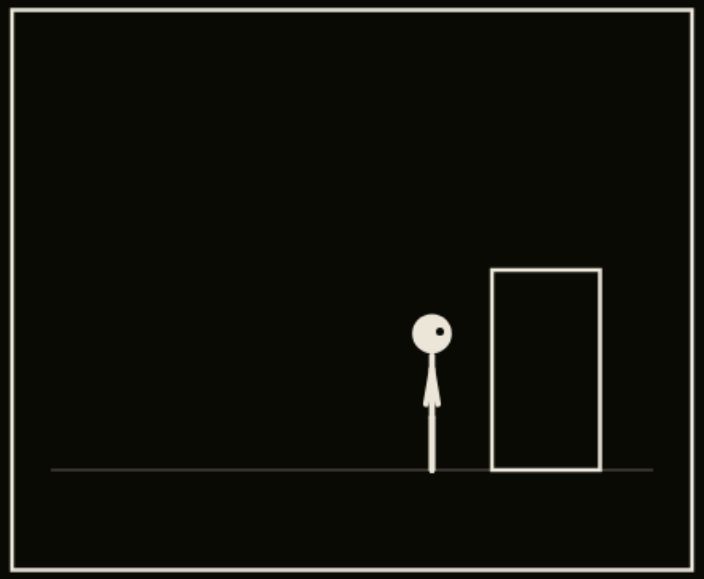


prompt

reference — changed it

constraint — changed it

outcome



more detail

more detail

set aside

Thick prompting needs a stopping rule.

Thick prompting needs a stopping rule. More detail is not automatically more situated or more helpful. Keep an addition when it changes something: reference, constraint, action, continuity, interpretation, or judgment. Record why it was made, and whether it changed the outcome.

What Bolas does. Bolas adds context cards to a prompt one at a time. When a card changes the outcome, the figure in the outcome frame moves and the card stays; when nothing changes, Bolas sets the card aside. Then it stops adding.

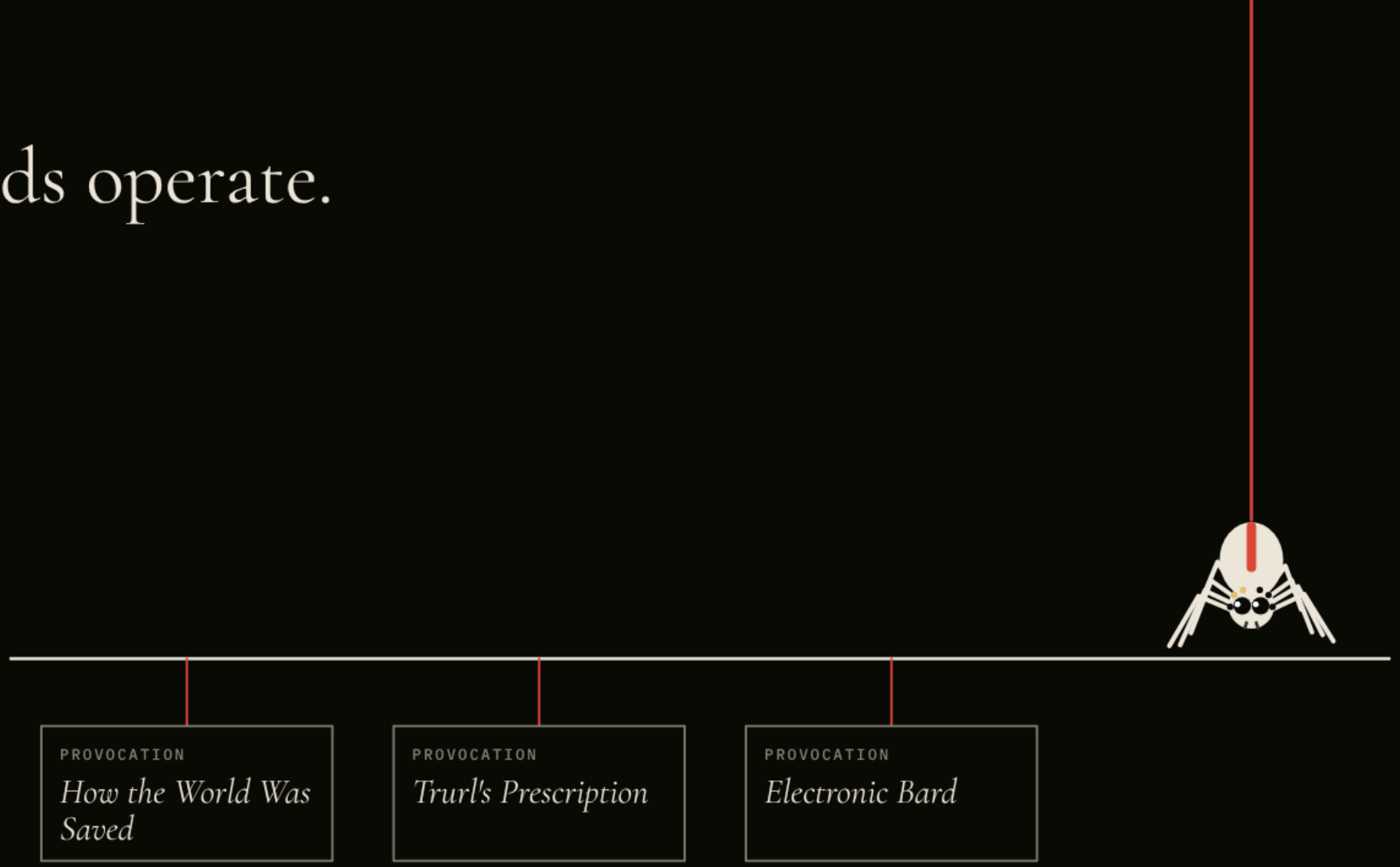
Atlas, insight 3: accumulation should be selected by what it changes: reference, constraint, action, continuity, interpretation, or judgment. Record why a contextual addition was made and whether it changed the relevant outcome.

Boundary: thickness is not token count. Community acceptance requires evidence from the social encounter, not prompt quality alone.

EXPERIMENT I

When words operate.

I



PROVOCATION

How the World Was Saved

PROVOCATION

Trurl's Prescription

PROVOCATION

Electronic Bard

When words operate.

Experiment one. When words operate. How does a description become an instruction, a creative artifact, or a rule someone can act upon? The Cyberiad stories are provocations for these experiments. The working systems and documented encounters supply the evidence.

What Bolas does. Bolas drops onto threshold I. Three story titles hang from the line as tags marked provocation.

Question: how does a description become an instruction, a creative artifact, or a rule someone can act upon? Initial question: can a description produce something? Harder question: can we determine what it did and correct it?

Chapters 3 to 5: A Wink Is an Interpretation; The House That Language Built; The Beautiful Wrong Answer.

Demonstration: one description, several realizations, one consequential mismatch, and a revision that changes what becomes possible. Contribution: an account of operative description grounded in situated use.

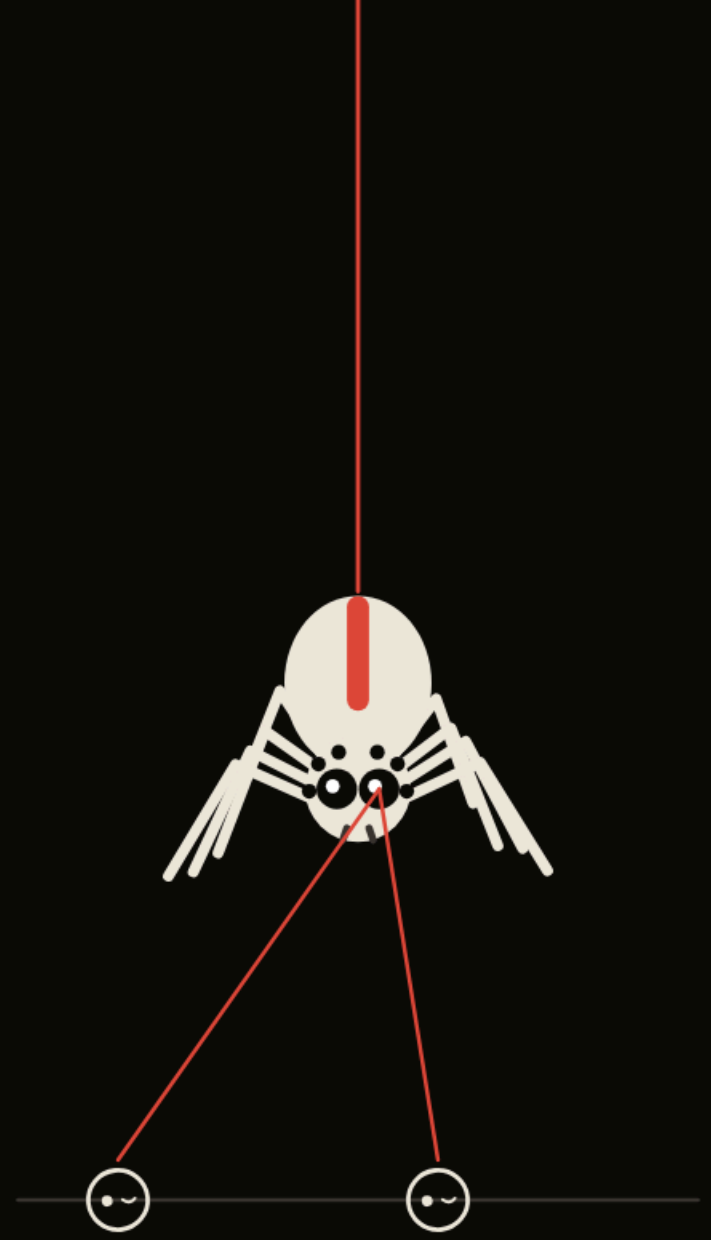
> Status: the Cyberiad groupings are provocations. The atlas did not inspect the story texts or establish that their fictional events validate any finding.

EXPERIMENT I

A wink is an interpretation.



a closing eye



a reading someone made

A wink is an interpretation.

A wink is an interpretation. Two movements can look alike while doing different things. Two outputs can resemble each other while occupying different roles: illustration, instruction, parody, testimony, invitation.

What Bolas does. Two Bolases close the same eye at the same speed, twice. The movements are identical. Only on the right does a thread run from the closed eye to a mark on the timeline: a reading someone made.

Chapter 3. Question: what surrounding activity makes a gesture or instruction intelligible? Section 3.1: surface movement and situated significance, the blink and wink distinction (Ryle, via Geertz). See Wink, Not Blink in this set.

Correction carried from the atlas: a wink itself is not a thin observation. Distinguish observed movement from its interpretation.

EXPERIMENT I

Put that there.



Put that there.

Wittgenstein's builders give the minimal scene: words work through a learned arrangement of people, objects, expectations, and actions. Tap a stone to bind that. Tap the ground to bind there. Then give the instruction. Keep the words fixed and change the bindings. The words stay the same; what they do changes.

What Bolas does. PUT THAT THERE stays fixed above. Bolas taps a stone and THAT binds to it, taps the ground and THERE binds to it, and carries the stone there. Then the threads move to another stone and another place, and Bolas carries that one. The words never change.

> Observed source: the Builders' Game interface invites block, pillar, slab and beam calls, tapping a stone to bind THAT, and tapping ground to bind THERE.

> Proposed comparison: hold the utterance "put that there" constant while changing the selected object or ground point; compare explicit bindings with an ambiguous reference condition; record the actual bindings and resulting action. Missing work: capture a short actual trace.

"Wittgenstein's Waymo": a provisional chapter vignette about deictic language in a changing environment (that, there, stop, safe). No inspected artifact established it as a completed project or a tested autonomous-vehicle study.

Failure to look for: an apparently successful command acted on the wrong referent.

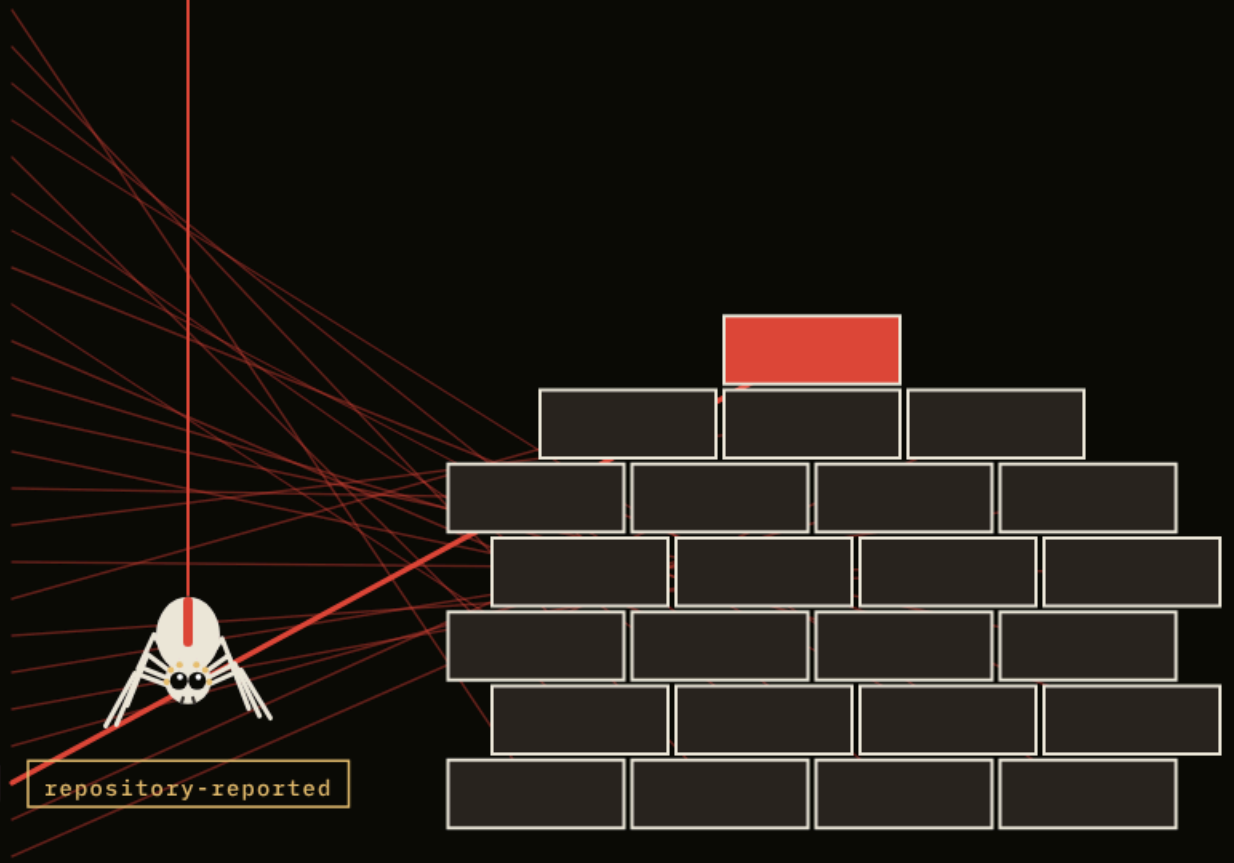
line 22 · repository-reported

The house that language built.

source (illustrative)

```
 1  1 4 -60 0 0 ... 3001.dat
 2  1 15 -20 0 0 ... 3001.dat
 3  1 1 20 0 0 ... 3001.dat
 4  1 14 60 0 0 ... 3001.dat
 5  1 4 -60 -24 0 ... 3001.dat
 6  1 15 -20 -24 0 ... 3001.dat
 7  1 1 20 -24 0 ... 3001.dat
 8  1 14 60 -24 0 ... 3001.dat
 9  1 4 -60 -48 0 ... 3001.dat
10  1 15 -20 -48 0 ... 3001.dat
11  1 1 20 -48 0 ... 3001.dat
12  1 14 60 -48 0 ... 3001.dat
13  1 4 -60 -72 0 ... 3001.dat
14  1 15 -20 -72 0 ... 3001.dat
15  1 1 20 -72 0 ... 3001.dat
16  1 14 60 -72 0 ... 3001.dat
17  1 4 -60 -96 0 ... 3001.dat
18  1 15 -20 -96 0 ... 3001.dat
19  1 1 20 -96 0 ... 3001.dat
20  1 14 60 -96 0 ... 3001.dat
21  1 4 -60 -120 0 ... 3001.dat
22  1 15 -20 -120 0 ... 3001.dat
23  1 1 20 -120 0 ... 3001.dat
24  1 14 60 -120 0 ... 3001.dat
```

parse → place → connect → assemble → repair



The house that language built.

The house that language built. Parse, place, connect, assemble, repair. The LEGO essay reports a failure at line twenty-two. The object stayed visible, while the link between visible parts and source lines became unreliable. The appearance survived; the authoring relationship broke.

What Bolas does. Bolas reads source lines one at a time and lays a brick for each, tied to its line by a thread, until a house stands. At line 22 the threads slip: the house looks the same, but pulling line 22 lights the wrong brick.

Chapter 4. Question: what distinguishes a generated appearance from something that can be constructed and revised? The LEGO essay proposes parse, place, connect, assemble, repair as distinct levels; LDraw as an inspectable intermediate representation.

> Repository-reported: the essay's "Line 22 collapse", in which optimization preserved appearance while losing reliable correspondence between selected geometry and source instruction. It remains a claim in project documentation until checked against the underlying record. The source lines drawn on this slide are illustrative, not the essay's.

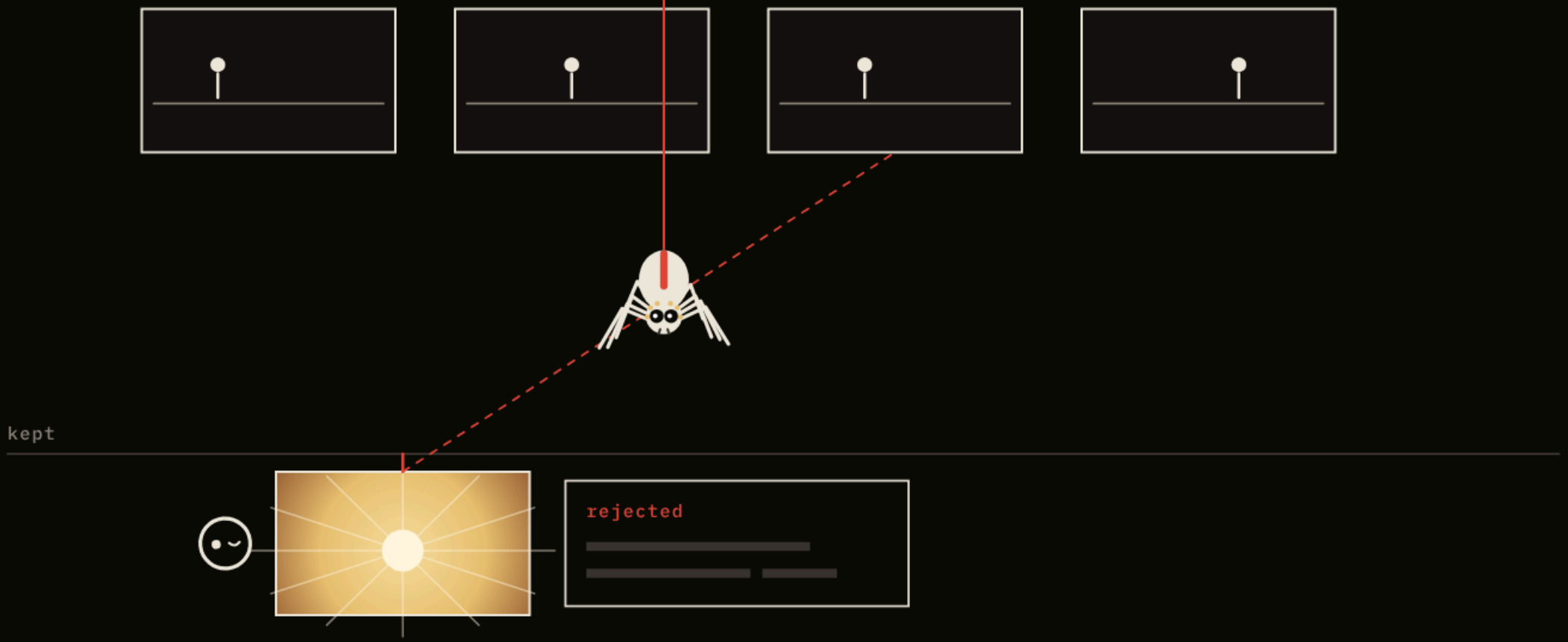
> Proposed comparison: follow one assembly or building change through instruction, source address, visible geometry, constraint check, and repair. Missing work: locate the underlying defect and repair record.

Links: Can a Language Model Build With LEGO?; Henry House: Operative Builder Trace; Terrarium theory and defect record; Fourth Shield.

Boundary: a digital constraint check does not certify a building's safety or a physical assembly's performance.

EXPERIMENT I

The rejected version is evidence.



The rejected version is evidence.

The beautiful wrong answer. A compelling output can settle an interpretation too early. What did the poem ask of the sequence? Which attractive version was rejected, which relation did it fail to preserve, and what revision changed the work? The rejected version is evidence. It makes judgment visible.

What Bolas does. Two candidates for one frame of a sequence: one bright and full, one plain. Bolas puts the plain one into the sequence and pins the bright one to a line below with a note of why, instead of throwing it away.

Chapter 5. Play, Freedom, and AI Films gives the problem: fluent conventions can arrive before a film establishes what they should mean. The Multiplane Animation Studio procedure: drawing, looking, comparing, adjusting, playing back. Ground it in one passage of Mark Anthony Thomas's poems (WYGWYL Atlas).

> Proposed comparison: show one attractive but unsuitable realization beside the selected version and explain exactly which poetic or sequential relation differs. Evidence to assemble: rejected and accepted versions with contemporaneous reasons where available; distinguish retrospective interpretation from recorded production judgment.

Boundary: preserve Mark Anthony Thomas's particular authored perspective; do not infer his response where none is documented.

EXPERIMENT II

When models become worlds.

II



PROVOCATION
Seventh Sally

PROVOCATION
Dragons of Probability

PROVOCATION
Three Storytelling Machines

When models become worlds.

Experiment two. When models become worlds. What changes when a description must sustain relations across time, space, and multiple encounters? A door needs somewhere to lead. A remembered event needs consequences. A route needs to remain traversable from another position.

What Bolas does. Bolas drops onto threshold II, behind it the thread from the first. Three story titles hang from the line as tags marked provocation.

Question: what changes when a description must sustain relations across time, space, and multiple encounters? Initial: can descriptions generate an environment? Harder: can its relations and consequences persist across encounters?

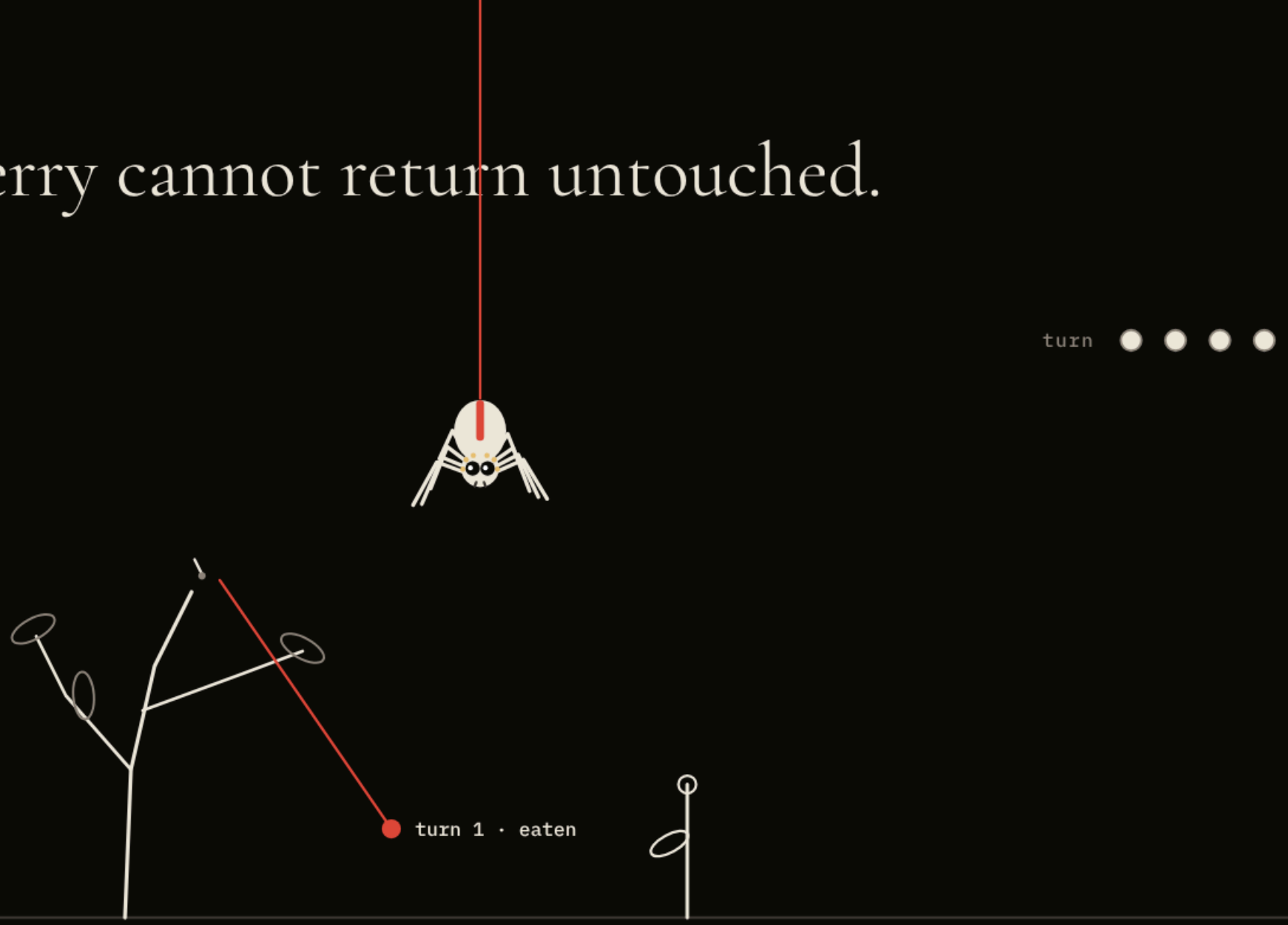
Here worldtext becomes necessary: the organization of descriptions, media, rules, and actions through which a world remains available to experience and revision. Chapters 6 to 8.

Demonstration: follow one passage through a poem, alternative cuts, and a spatial realization; show what each version preserves, introduces, or makes impossible. Contribution: worldtext as a framework for studying continuity and transformation across representations and actions.

> Status: the story titles are provocations, not evidence.

EXPERIMENT II

The blueberry cannot return untouched.



run 2 · state kept

The blueberry cannot return untouched.

The blueberry cannot return untouched. A bird eats a berry. A few turns later, the berry is back, untouched. What must remain after an action for later events to carry its consequences? Run it again with the state kept: the stem stays bare, and what the bird dropped can grow.

What Bolas does. A bird takes the berry; the turn counter runs; the berry reappears on the stem. Bolas rewinds the counter and runs it again with the state kept: the stem stays bare, a knot is tied for the event, and a seed the bird dropped grows over the turns.

Chapter 6. Coaxing the Ripples supplies the opening: a bird eats a berry, yet the berry returns untouched; the presentation contrasts this with a later ecological trace and proposes that entity appearance needs a causal path (migration or growth). Poetry Pond adds that previewing an earlier state differs from restoring it.

> Status: presentation example, not a completed experimental run. Proposed comparison: trace one action for several turns under prose-only continuation and explicit state handling, if both can be implemented with the existing artifacts.

Boundary: persistence does not require irreversibility. Undo, branching and restoration are authored actions that also need an explicit history.

EXPERIMENT II

A poem becomes a place.



House of Dust

Shield Grid

TEXT-URE

Association Field

WYGWYL Atlas

A poem becomes a place.

A poem becomes a place. Four variable lines make a dwelling. Text segments take addresses. Navigation samples a texture. A path through footage becomes a sequence. Locations, buildings and routes make a city. A poem organizes possible encounters; a reader, editor, or player makes a consequential path through them.

What Bolas does. Bolas carries one red line through five forms in turn: under one of four lines of a house, through a grid of addressed cells, across a texture, through a field of clips into a strip, and along the routes of a small city.

Chapter 7. The progression the forage found:

ARTIFACT	WHAT LANGUAGE ORGANIZES
House of Dust	A dwelling through four variable lines (credits Knowles and Tenney)
Shield Grid	Addressed cells and traversal
TEXT-URE	Navigation and sampling
Association Field	A path through footage that becomes a sequence
WYGWYL Atlas	Locations, buildings, routes, and a city

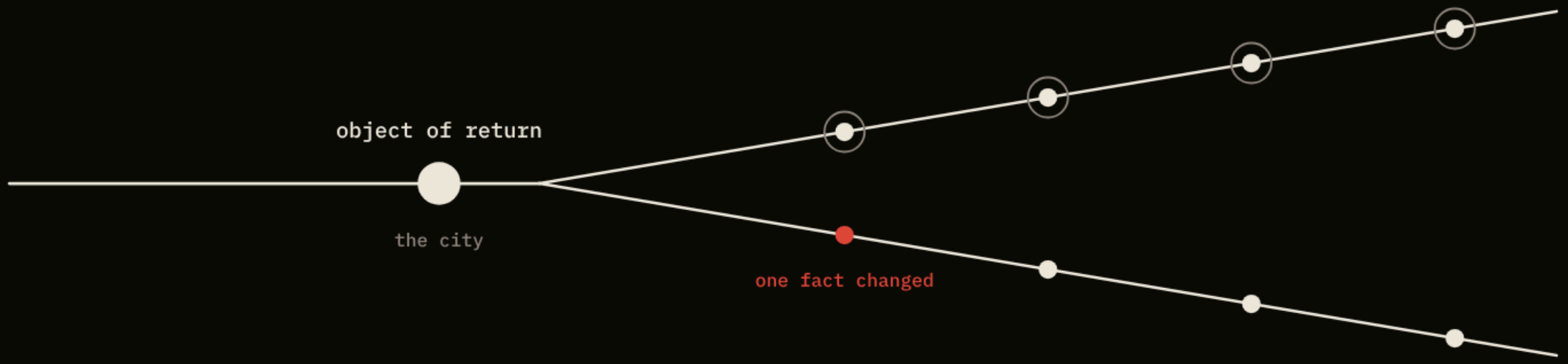
> Observed in source: the interfaces above. Proposed comparison: use one passage to compare a grid, a media field, and a spatial scene; analyze interface affordances rather than asserting reader effects without evidence.

Boundary: a coordinate does not measure meaning; a spatial interface does not become a coherent world simply by adding 3D graphics.

EXPERIMENT II

proposed comparison

Change one fact in one branch.



Change one fact in one branch.

The histories a world keeps. A city can become a refuge, an obstacle, and an object of return. A character who refused an invitation has a different history from one who never received it. Change one fact in one branch, continue both, and check whether that change leaks between histories.

What Bolas does. One entity travels a story line while its role changes: refuge, obstacle, object of return. The line forks. Bolas turns one knot red on the lower branch, both branches continue, and Bolas walks the upper branch checking each knot.

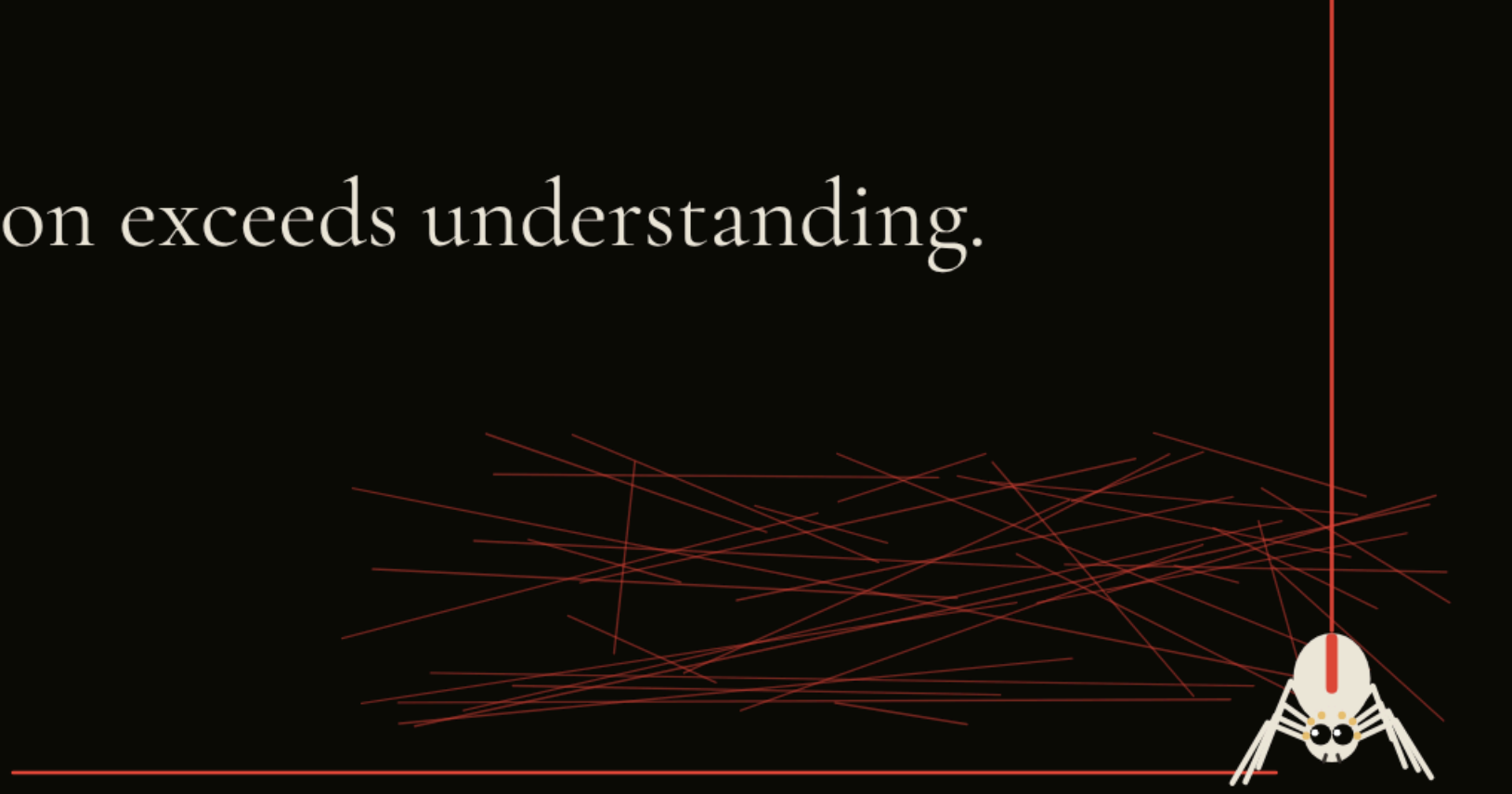
Chapter 8. Question: what must a world remember about the alternatives it did not select? After the Scene separates an entity's identity from its narrative function and discusses branch-specific state; it notes that preserving branches is better developed than comparing or merging them. See also LEGOS and Centaur Box.

> Proposed comparison: change a fact in one branch, continue both, and inspect whether the change crosses into the other. Document restoration separately from continuation. The slide shows the procedure, not a result.

Boundary: explicit branch storage does not prove that a model understands nested realities.

EXPERIMENT III

When description exceeds understanding.



III

PROVOCATION

Demon of the Second Kind

PROVOCATION

Altruizine

PROVOCATION

Trap of Gargantius

When description exceeds understanding.

Experiment three. When description exceeds understanding. What happens when individually intelligible descriptions generate collectively unintelligible consequences? A system can satisfy a local condition while undermining the activity that gave the condition its purpose.

What Bolas does. Bolas drops onto threshold III. The threads behind it have become a tangle. Three story titles hang from the line as tags marked provocation.

Question: what happens when individually intelligible descriptions generate collectively unintelligible consequences? Initial: can we generate and retrieve more? Harder: can we interpret, contest, and take responsibility for what accumulates? Chapters 9 to 11.

More context can overwhelm attention. More plausible footage can make selection harder. This experiment asks what an operator needs to notice, question, and revise such consequences; it connects the attention tax to infrastructure, provenance, responsibility, and the limits of prompting.

Demonstration: compare exhaustive retrieval with a bounded, situated selection process. Contribution: criteria for examining when operative descriptions remain legible and revisable as their consequences accumulate.

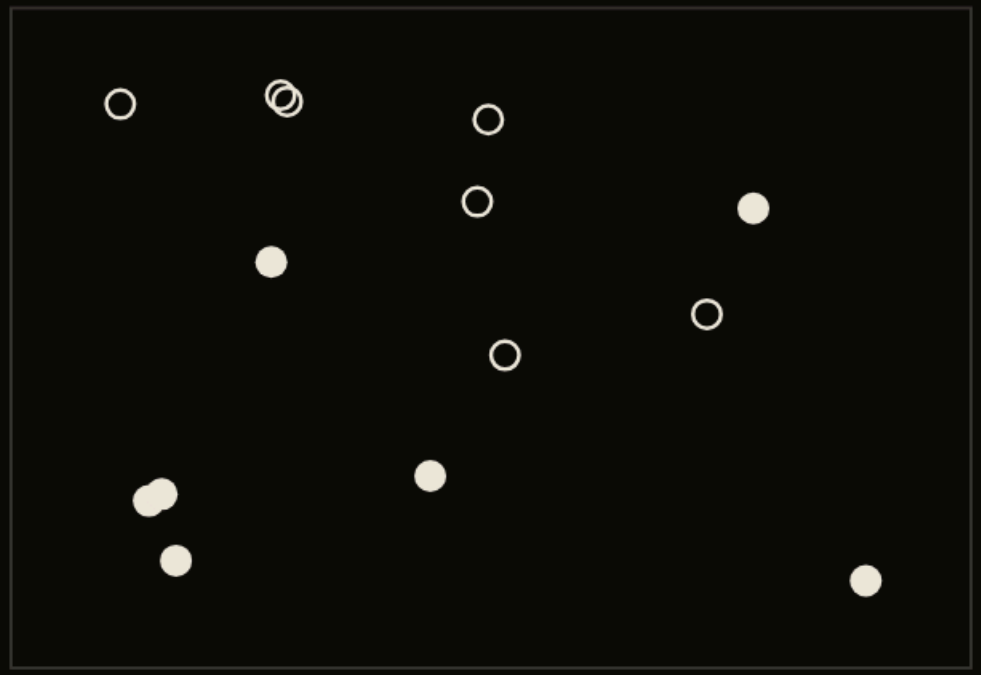
> Status: the story titles are provocations, not evidence.

EXPERIMENT III

Change a parameter, or change the account.

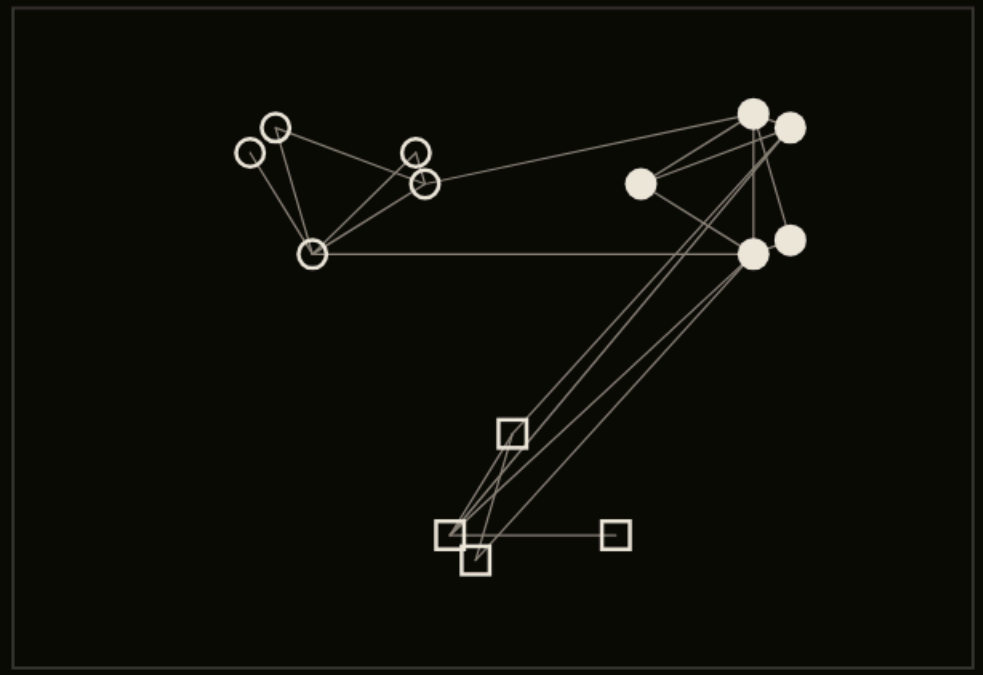


parameter change



a · speed

ontology change



a · redefined

Change a parameter, or change the account.

The model changes what it can see. Changing a parameter within an account is one thing. Changing the account that determines what the parameters mean is another. A successful simulation demonstrates the consequences of its assumptions. Historical adequacy requires a further argument.

What Bolas does. On the left Bolas turns a dial and the same dots move faster. On the right it redraws the account: the dots regroup into new kinds, links form between them, and the label above the dial changes.

Chapter 9. Growing Entanglements examines the passage from historical accounts to actors, motives, variables and rules (rival Sahlins and Obeyesekere interpretations; seven simplified mechanisms) and criticizes its own simplifications. It explicitly refuses to identify the demonstrations with a reconstruction of Hawaiian experience.

> Proposed comparison: select one mechanism, not all seven; hold an outcome in view while changing the assumptions that define the agents and relations; document the interpretation behind each rule.

Boundary: reproducing an outcome is not sufficient causal validation. Avoid coding practical and symbolic as a universal opposition.

EXPERIMENT III

The archive cannot be read all at once.





wg_050 · WarGames, 1983

present — a hand on a door

research — a principal sees David out

might do — a courtesy, or a control

excluded · reasons kept

The archive cannot be read all at once.

The archive cannot be read all at once. Different models make different material retrievable. Keep three claims apart: what is visibly present, what contextual research makes intelligible, and what the passage might do in a new composition. Keep the candidates, the exclusions, and the reasons for the final cut.

What Bolas does. A wall of hundreds of frames; Bolas's sight covers a few at a time. It pulls three candidates, plays one (wg_050, a hand on a door, from The Play), ties three separate claims to it, and hangs the two it excluded on a side line with their reasons.

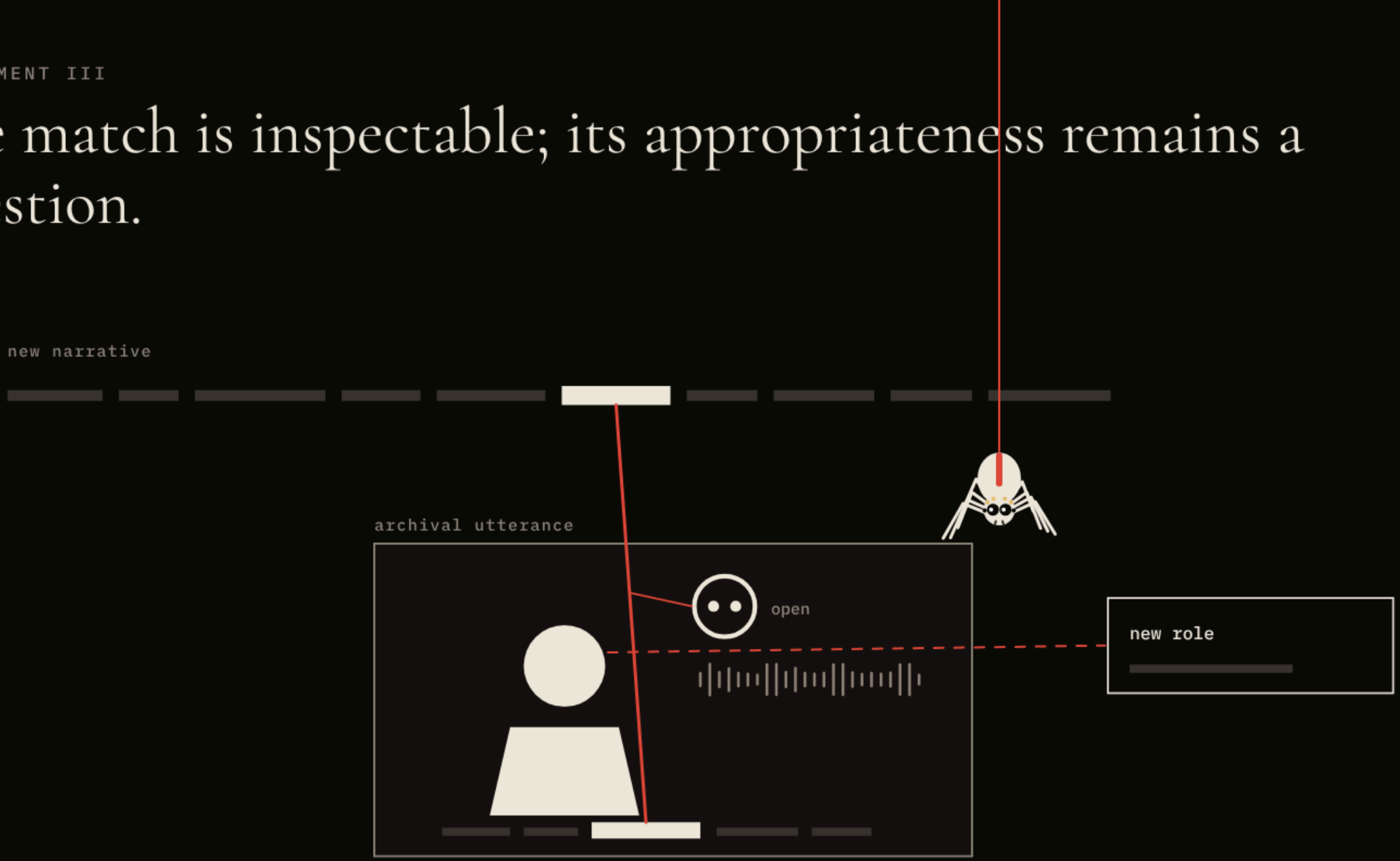
Chapter 10. Use Cineosis Lab, Found Odyssey, Syntagm Lab and Attention Infrastructure. Keep three claims separately attributed: what is visibly or audibly present; what contextual research makes intelligible; what the passage might do in a new composition.

> Observed: the clip on this slide is wg_050 from *WarGames* (1983), returned by the lab for sign 11 and followed frame by frame in The Play. The three claims on the slide come from that page. The other frames are placeholders.

> Proposed comparison: retrieve candidates for one passage through two documented lenses; preserve candidates, exclusions, source context, and the reasons for the final cut. Do not assume that a model name by itself establishes a distinct way of seeing. No requirement to annotate the entire archive.

EXPERIMENT III

The match is inspectable; its appropriateness remains a question.



The match is inspectable; its appropriateness remains a question.

In Found Odyssey, a shared word brings an archival utterance into a new narrative. The match is inspectable; its appropriateness remains a question. The original speaker's recorded words do not establish agreement with the new role.

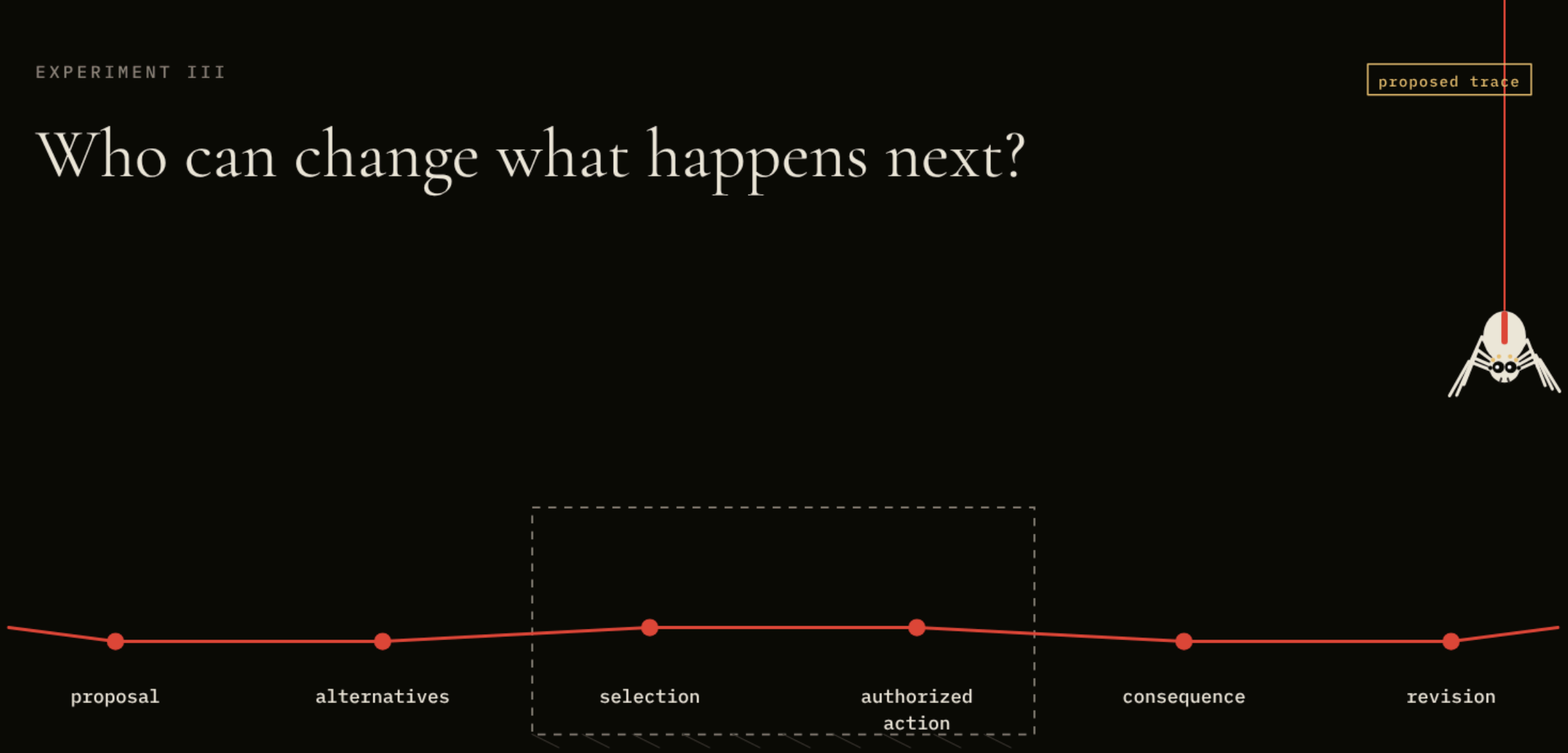
What Bolas does. Bolas ties the same word in two places, a line of the new story and a clip of someone speaking. The thread holds. Bolas hangs an open mark on it, both eyes open: a question not yet settled. The line from the speaker to the new role stays dashed.

Found Odyssey: a shared word brings an archival utterance into a new narrative. The match is inspectable; its appropriateness remains a question.

> Status: the current Found Odyssey program is an adapted retelling, not verified correspondence to every Greek verse. Missing work: record source context, alternatives, and revised use for one archive answer.

EXPERIMENT III

Who can change what happens next?



Who can change what happens next?

Who can change what happens next? Follow one trace: proposal, alternatives, selection, authorized action, consequence, revision. The question is which participant could inspect or change each relation. A visible button is not sufficient evidence of meaningful power.

What Bolas does. Six knots on one thread. Bolas walks the trace and tugs each link. Some give and move; two sit behind a line Bolas cannot cross and do not move when tugged.

Chapter 11. Centaur Box exposes stages behind a reply (memo, model, plan, draft, send). The Pronoun Alibi examines how attribution changes after consequences; The Adviser Leaves the Room extends this to reliance and duty. The ICARO causal patch console presents before and after changes with apply and discard decisions. See also Ethics Infrastructure.

> Proposed: follow one actual trace, if available, through proposal, alternatives, selection, authorized action, consequence, revision. Which links are movable on this slide is illustrative. Some Centaur Box examples are response structures rather than live runs; the legal and medical cases in the essays need primary-source verification.

Boundary: local interface revision does not establish control over a model provider, contract, deployment policy, or a represented community's interests.

The argument connecting them



EXPERIMENT	WHAT MUST BE ESTABLISHED	CHARACTERISTIC FAILURE
Words operate	An utterance works within a situated activity	The output resembles the request but cannot support its purpose
Models become worlds	Relations persist across encounters	Convincing fragments fail to form a coherent environment
Description exceeds understanding	Consequences remain inspectable and revisable	Locally successful operations produce an opaque or harmful whole

The argument connecting them

The argument connecting them. Words operate: an utterance works within a situated activity. The failure: the output resembles the request but cannot support its purpose. Models become worlds: relations persist across encounters. The failure: convincing fragments fail to form a coherent environment. Description exceeds understanding: consequences remain inspectable and revisable. The failure: locally successful operations produce an opaque or harmful whole.

What Bolas does. The table fills one row at a time. For each row Bolas ties a thread from what must be established to its characteristic failure.

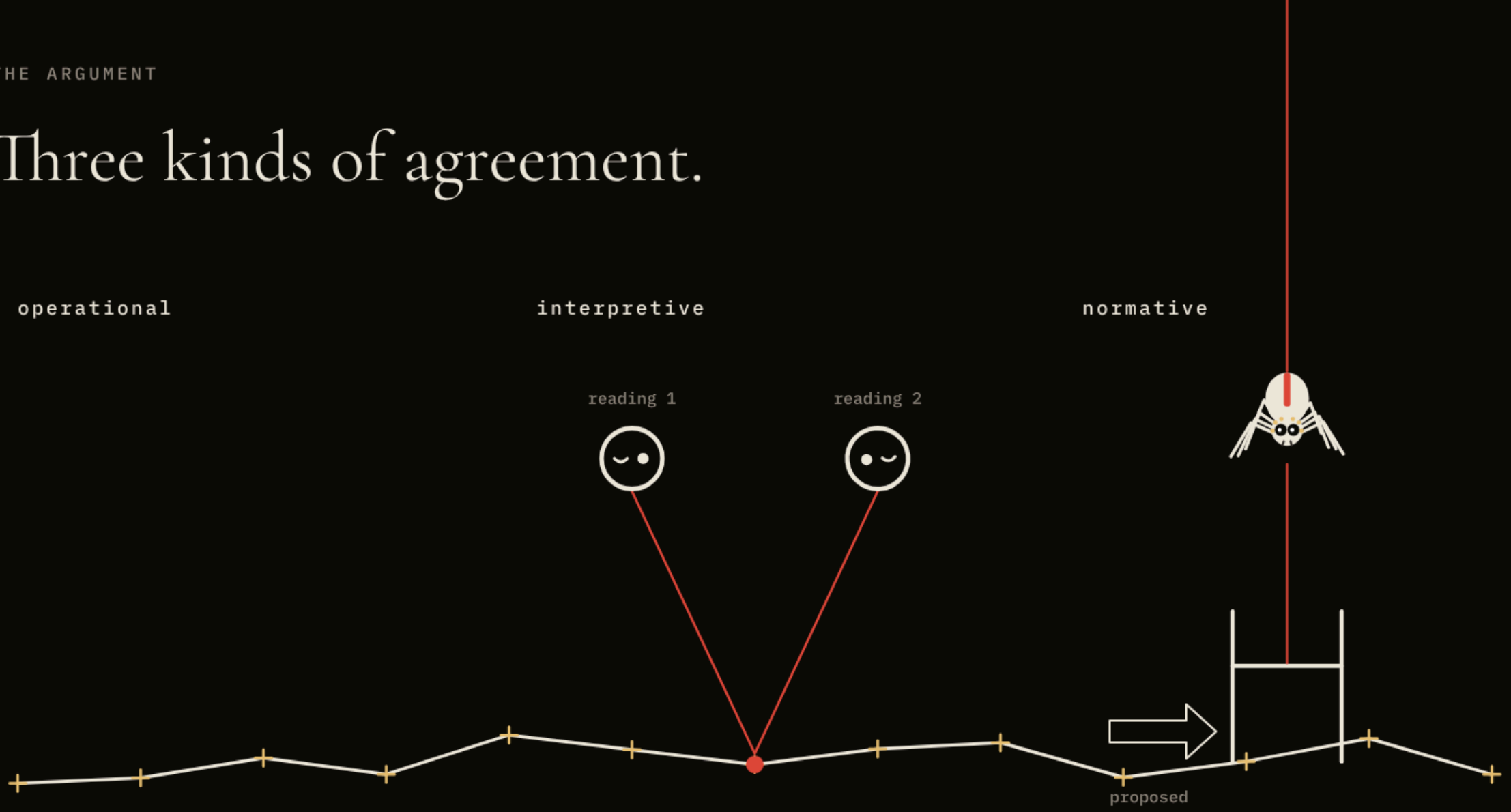
The argument table, from the experiments document: what must be established, and the characteristic failure, for each experiment.

Three kinds of agreement.

operational

interpretive

normative



measured drawn

Three kinds of agreement.

Three kinds of agreement must be kept apart. Operational: does the described state match what the program draws and acts upon? Interpretive: do different people give an event the same meaning? Normative: should the proposed action or interpretation be accepted? The ground drawn by a program should agree with the ground it measures. Different accounts of what happened on that ground may need to remain available together.

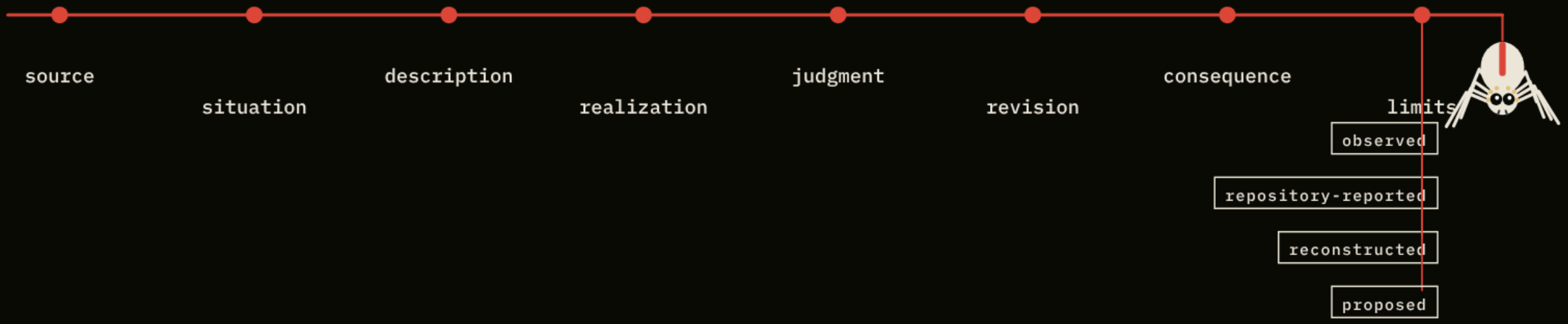
What Bolas does. Bolas pulls a drawn ground line onto the measured points until they agree. Two readings of one event on that ground then hang side by side, both kept. A proposed step waits at a gate while Bolas holds the bar.

Atlas, insight 2. Operational agreement: does the described state match what the program draws and acts upon? Interpretive agreement: do different people or descriptions give an event the same meaning? Normative agreement: should the proposed action or interpretation be accepted?

Terrarium theory and defect record argues for one authoritative surface representation; Growing Entanglements argues for preserving incompatible causal interpretations. Both can be right: a program needs consistent answers about its current state without making one cultural reading the only legitimate account.

Use technical checks for explicit constraints and argued close reading for interpretive consequences. Do not collapse them into a single universal score.

One record per consequential episode.



One record per consequential episode.

Build an episode record for each consequential encounter: source, situation, description, realization, judgment, revision, consequence, limits. Each record says what it is: observed, repository-reported, reconstructed, or proposed. Add a project only when it supplies missing evidence.

What Bolas does. Bolas spins a thread and ties eight knots, one as each part is named, ending at limits. Four status tags hang from the end of the thread.

Episode record (atlas): question and experiment set; source passage, artifact version and location; situation and participants; description and supplied context; referent bindings, state, or governing rules; produced realization; accepted and rejected alternatives; criterion of judgment and who supplied it; revision and consequence; rival interpretation; what the episode supports and what it cannot establish; record status.

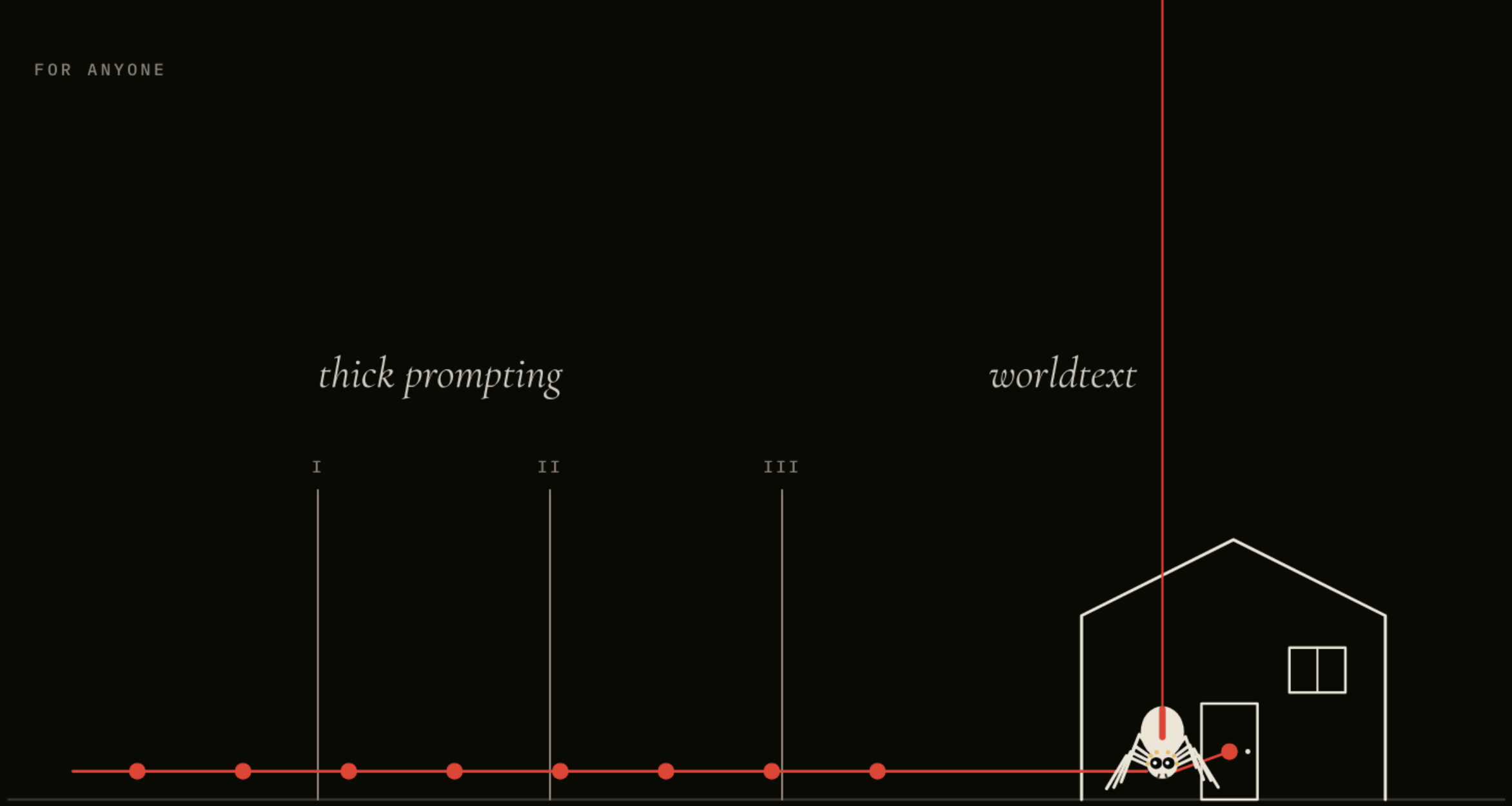
Three evidence tracks: A, textual and interpretive evidence (why a reading is warranted); B, operational evidence (what a system actually did under stated conditions); C, situated practice evidence (how a decision emerged in production).

A compact evidence slate: eight episodes (THAT/THERE binding; one part repaired; one poem realization refused; one action persists; one passage takes two paths; one historical rule has rival readings; one archive answer reconsidered; one proposed change inspected). An initial selection, not a demand for eight new systems.

Writing order: The House That Language Built; The Blueberry Cannot Return Untouched; The Beautiful Wrong Answer; The Archive Cannot Be Read All at Once; then the method and introduction.

thick prompting

worldtext



The story for anyone

The dissertation follows description across three thresholds: when words guide actions, when those actions compose worlds, and when their accumulated consequences exceed what an individual instruction makes intelligible. I investigate these thresholds through building systems, poetic translation, and operative archives. Thick prompting is the method for documenting the contextual knowledge, judgments, and revisions involved. Worldtext names the organization of language, media, rules, and actions that emerges across these practices. The contribution is an account of how descriptions become operative, supported by working artifacts and production histories that expose both their possibilities and their limits.

What Bolas does. Bolas walks back across the three thresholds to the house from the opening. The door is still only drawn, but now Bolas ties a thread from it to an episode record: the discrepancy can be found, inspected and revised.

"The story for anyone", Watson's closing paragraph, read whole.

What to show Jay first: the three experiment sets as the dissertation's questions; three bounded case families as its evidence base; the chapter architecture as writing modules; one fully documented episode showing the intended method; a list of missing evidence, distinct from desired new features.

Chapter 12 returns to the opening discrepancy: operational consistency and interpretive plurality require different treatment.

From Imagetext to Worldtext

Watson Hartsoe · Georgia Tech, Digital Media · adviser Jay David Bolter · 16 October 2026

From Imagetext to Worldtext

From imagetext to worldtext. Watson Hartsoe.

What Bolas does. The title thread stays. Bolas climbs its own thread up and out of the frame.

Sources: Watson Hartsoe, the three experiments and "the story for anyone"; the accumulating question and twelve chapter modules; "From Imagetext to Worldtext: a chapter architecture developed by foraging Elsewhere" (15 October 2026). Bolas is the Cineosis Lab avatar, after *Spider Engineers* (1956).